GETTYSBURG INTERACTIVE MAP

USER GUIDE

GETTING STARTED

What it is: A free animated map of the Battle of Gettysburg, July 1–3, 1863. 467 regiments and batteries, 675 five-minute snapshots of the entire engagement. No login required.
Access: Visit gettysburginteractivemap.com in any modern browser. Chrome recommended for best performance.
First launch: A short walkthrough, then choose Desktop or Mobile layout. Switch anytime from the Tools menu.

PLAYBACK

Key	Action	Key	Action
Space	Play / Pause	1 / 2 / 3	Jump to July 1 / 2 / 3
→ / ←	Step one tick	+ / –	Speed up / slow down
Shift+→/←	Jump 1 hour	0	Reset to 1× speed
S	Search units	F	Filter panel
L	Toggle legend	M	Toggle minimap
H	Heatmap	B	Bookmarks
?	Help modal	Esc	Close any panel

Speed settings: ¼× · ½× · 1× · 2× · 4× · 8×
Timeline scrubber: Click or drag to any tick. Colored dots mark key events (red = critical, gold = significant).
Day tabs: July 1 = ticks 1–225 · July 2 = ticks 226–450 · July 3 = ticks 451–675

MAP & UNITS

Unit dots: Blue = Union Red = Confederate. Dot size scales with unit strength. Fill color shows disposition.
Click any dot to open the Unit Detail panel — commander, strength, casualties, recent positions.
Toggle Units button: Shows or hides all unit dots on the map (battlefield view stays visible).
Minimap: Overview canvas in the bottom-right. Click to navigate the main map.

Disposition	Color	Disposition	Color
Line of Battle	Blue	Chaotic Retreat	Orange
Charging Line	Red	Reserve	Green
Skirmish Line	Lt. Blue	Bivouac	Olive
Deployed Artillery	Yellow	Limbered Artillery	Gold
Mounted Cavalry	Teal	Dismounted Cavalry	Dk. Green

TOOLBAR TOOLS

S — Search

Find any unit by name, state, regiment, or commander. Sort results by relevance or casualty percentage. Quick links to notable units (20th Maine, 1st Minnesota, etc.).

F — Filter

Show Union only, Confederate only, or filter by unit type (Infantry / Cavalry / Artillery), disposition, or minimum strength.

Find Unit / Location

A dedicated quick-jump search separate from the Filter panel — type a unit or place name to fly straight there.

Toggle Units
Show or hide all unit dots. The map and all other features remain active.

L — Legend
Color key for dispositions, sides, and unit size. Three tabs: Disposition / Sides / Size.

M — Minimap
Toggle the overview minimap in the bottom-right corner. Click the minimap to navigate.

H — Heatmap
Toggle the casualty heatmap overlay showing intensity of losses across the field.

B — Bookmarks
Save the current tick, unit selection, and map position. Share a permalink.

? — Help
Full in-app reference and keyboard shortcut list.

Virtual Walkthrough
16 NPS Auto Tour stops with historical narration, Google Street View, and NPS video links. Monuments tab: search all 512 battlefield monuments.

Order of Battle
Full hierarchical order of battle — all Union and Confederate corps, divisions, brigades, and regiments with current strength and disposition.

Unit Roster
Flat list of all units on the field at the current tick, color-coded by side.

Monuments
Toggle 512 monument dots on the map. Click any monument to jump to its tick and see details. Active units glow gold.

Soldier's Eye View
Google Street View panoramas from 8 key battlefield positions (Little Round Top, The Angle, McPherson Ridge, Devil's Den, and more).

Follow Ancestor
Search for a regiment and track it through all 675 ticks. Gold trail glows on the map. Share a permalink with ?ancestor= parameter.

Distance Tool
Click point A on the map, then point B. Displays feet, yards, meters, and estimated infantry march time. Click again to reset.

Map Layers
Toggle 1863 roads, road labels, rivers, river labels, breastworks, farm outlines, and farm labels.

Locations
Toggle battlefield location name labels (Cemetery Hill, Little Round Top, etc.).

NPS Auto Tour
16 official NPS Auto Tour stops with narration, Google Street View, and NPS video — embedded in the Virtual Walkthrough panel.

VIRTUAL WALKTHROUGH — NPS AUTO TOUR STOPS

1 McPherson Ridge · 2 Eternal Light Peace Memorial · 3 Oak Ridge · 4 North Carolina Memorial · 5 Virginia Memorial · 6 Pitzer Woods · 7 Warfield Ridge · 8 Little Round Top · 9 The Wheatfield · 10 The Peach Orchard · 11 Plum Run · 12 Pennsylvania Memorial · 13 Spangler's Spring · 14 East Cemetery Hill · 15 High Water Mark · 16 Soldiers' National Cemetery

Each stop includes: historical narration · embedded Google Street View · NPS video link. The **Monuments** tab lets you search all 512 battlefield monuments by name, side, or group.

THE EXTRA FEATURES MENU

Twenty additional tools, top right on the map, organized by what you're trying to do — not by when they were built. Ask the Historian is pinned separately since it's the one most worth trying first.

Drive the map yourself	
Search Everything	Find any regiment, place, or moment by name.
Compare Moments	Two maps side by side at two different times.
Camera Modes	Auto-fly to the action, or follow one unit.
What They Could See	Real elevation, ranked by vantage point.
What-If Sandbox	Drag units and explore hypotheticals, just for fun.
Get the story explained	
Ask the Historian *	A search-and-answer assistant built from the map's own records.
Documentary Mode	All 24 key moments, narrated, in order.
Turning Points	Nine decisions historians still argue over.
For Students	A simple, classroom-friendly walkthrough.
Aftermath	What happened after July 3rd.
Research a unit or ancestor	
Regimental Biography	One unit's whole battle, told as a single story.
Find Your Ancestor	Search regiments by state or commander's name.
Casualty Dashboard	Strength and losses, corps by corps.
Battle Reports	A printable one-page reference per regiment.
Feel the scale of it	
Immersive Mode	Live cannon and musket sound tied to real troop density.
The Living Ledger	The human cost, rising minute by minute.
The Ground Remembers	A heatmap that builds across all three days.
Battlefield AR	See historical vantage points through your phone, on-site.
Bring others along	
Watch Together	Build a guided tour and watch it live with someone else.
Cinematic Export	Export a real video of any stretch of the battle.

* Ask the Historian answers only from this site's own published data (regiments, vignettes, chronology, terrain) — a search-and-synthesis tool, not a live AI model, so every answer traces back to a real record on the site.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Issue	Fix
Blank screen or stuck loading	Use Chrome. Hard-refresh with Ctrl+Shift+R (Cmd+Shift+R on Mac).
Street View shows black	Google Street View loads from external servers — allow third-party content and disable aggressive ad blockers.
Panel won’t close	Press Escape, or click the × button on the panel.
Units not visible	Check that Toggle Units is ON (button in toolbar center). Also check the Filter panel — all sides and types should be selected.
Slow on mobile	Use the Mobile layout (select at startup or from Tools menu). Lower playback speed helps on older devices.
Can’t find a listed tool	It’s in the Extra Features menu, top right — grouped by Explore / Learn / Data & Records / Experience It / Share.
PDF won’t download	Right-click "Download Website Tutorial PDF" and choose Save link as.

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